



Climate Change AI

Call for Proposals: Climate Change AI Innovation Grants 2024

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Quick facts

- **Grant amount:** Up to USD 150K per proposal, for projects of 12 months in duration. We will award a total of up to USD 1.4M in grants across all projects.
- **Scope:** Projects at the intersection of AI/machine learning and climate change.
- **Eligibility:** Principal Investigator must be affiliated with an accredited university in one of the 38 OECD Member Countries (see list [here](#)). Co-Investigators can be located outside OECD Member countries and can be affiliated with non-research institutions, and there is no limit on the fraction of funding allocated to Co-Investigators.
- **Proposal submission deadline:** September 15, 2024 at 23:59 (Anywhere on Earth time, UTC-12)
- **Submission site:** <https://cmt3.research.microsoft.com/CCAIGrants2024>
- **Contact:** grants@climatechange.ai

The purpose of this grant

Artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning (ML) can help support climate change mitigation and adaptation, as well as climate science, across many different areas, for example energy, agriculture,



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insufficient knowledge transfer between relevant fields and sectors.

The relationship between AI and climate change is also nuanced, and can manifest in various ways that either contribute to or counteract climate action. Thus, the use of AI for climate action must be performed with considerations of impact, responsibility, and equity at the center.

With the support of [Quadrature Climate Foundation](#), [Google DeepMind](#), and [Global Methane Hub](#), we are excited to announce funding of up to USD 1.4M for projects at the intersection of AI and climate change. We are also grateful to the [Canada Hub of Future Earth](#) for serving as the fiscal sponsor for this program.

Grant information

This program will allocate grants of up to USD 150K for conducting projects of 1 year in duration.

As part of the project, the grantees must publish a documented dataset (or simulator), which was created by collating, labeling, and/or annotating existing data, and/or by collecting, simulating, or otherwise making available new data that can enable further research. We require the dataset to comply with the [FAIR Data Principles](#) (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable).

Projects are expected to result in a deployed project, scientific publications, or other public dissemination of results, and should include a carefully considered pathway to impactful deployment. All grant IP – e.g., the dataset/simulator produced and (if applicable) trained models or detailed descriptions of architectures and training procedures – must be made publicly available under an open license.

This year, there are two special tracks in addition to the main track. Submissions should be made to one of these three tracks (duplicate submissions made to multiple tracks may be disqualified). Climate Change AI may move submissions between tracks at the discretion of the Process Chairs.

Main Track

Projects in the Main Track should leverage AI or machine learning to address problems in climate change mitigation, adaptation, or climate science, or consider problems related to impact assessment and governance at the intersection of climate change and machine learning.

Relevant topics include but are not limited to the following topics:



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- ML applied to societal adaptation to climate change, including disaster prediction, management, and relief in relevant sectors
- ML for climate and Earth science, ecosystems, and natural systems as relevant to mitigation and adaptation
- ML for R&D of low-carbon technologies such as electrofuels and carbon capture & sequestration
- ML approaches in behavioral and social science related to climate change, including those anchored in climate finance and economics, climate justice, and climate policy
- Projects addressing AI governance in the context of climate change, or that aim to assess the greenhouse gas emissions impacts of AI or AI-driven applications, may also be eligible for funding. (Studies addressing this area may be exempt from the dataset publication requirement.)

For context, a list of the projects funded during past Innovation Grants cycles is available [here](#).

Special Track on Methane

Submissions to the Special Track on Methane should leverage AI or machine learning to address problems in methane-related climate change mitigation in the short/medium term period (well before 2040), including (but not limited to) the areas of:

- Energy (including coal mine methane, ventilation air methane, flaring, methane leak detection, super-emitters, and methane emissions from oil and gas)
- Waste and circular economy (including food loss and waste recovery, food or organic waste separation, dumps/landfill emissions, wastewater treatment, and sludge management)
- Agriculture (including livestock, manure management, biomass burning, and rice cultivation)

Special Track on Dataset Gaps

Submissions to the Special Track on Dataset Gaps should have, as their primary focus, the creation of a documented dataset (or simulator) by collating, labeling, and/or annotating existing data, and/or by collecting, simulating, or otherwise making available new data that can enable further research. **Such projects do not need to use AI or machine learning directly; rather, the goal is to establish a**



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address, and why this is important for climate change mitigation or adaptation.

Proposals in the Special Track on Dataset Gaps may also request support from a Google DeepMind researcher, in addition to the financial award. Applicants who may be interested in taking advantage of this option will be asked to indicate this in the CMT submission form.

Note: Proposals in the Special Track on Dataset Gaps may also propose research leveraging the dataset or simulator as part of the project; however, the primary focus of the project should be on the creation of the dataset or simulator itself. By contrast, projects in the Main Track must release a dataset or simulator but this need not be the primary focus of the project.

Eligibility

Each application must have a Principal Investigator (PI) who is affiliated with an accredited university in one of the 38 OECD Member Countries (see list [here](#)). The PI must be eligible to hold grants under their name at their accredited university; this may include, e.g., faculty, postdocs, or research scientists (depending on the institution). Co-Investigators can be located outside OECD Member countries and can be affiliated with non-research institutions, and indeed multi-country and multi-sectoral collaborations are encouraged. However, co-Investigators cannot be affiliated with an organization on the [Consolidated Screening List](#) or an organization in a sanctioned country (see [FAQ](#) for additional information).

Current members of the Climate Change AI Board of Directors and Climate Change AI staff cannot apply to this grant as a PI, and they may not receive funds towards their own salary. Program Chairs and Meta-Reviewers for this grant may not apply or receive funds in any way (however, Reviewers may, and conflicts of interest will be appropriately managed during the review process).

We do not fund research activity that is currently funded by other grant programs. If other grant proposals for the same project have been submitted and/or are under consideration, the relation of the present proposal to those other proposals needs to be clearly explained. If the proposal is selected for funding, no aspect of a project should be double funded by other funding bodies.

Timeline



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Informational webinars	July 30, 2024 @ 9 am ET/1 pm UTC recording August 15, 2024 @ 12 pm ET/4 pm UTC recording
Proposal submission deadline	September 15, 2024
Notification of results	December 2024
Award start date	February 2025
Award end date	February 2026

Selection criteria

Proposals will be reviewed through a single-blind process by independent reviewers.

Projects will be evaluated on the following criteria:

- **Climate relevance:** Projects should demonstrate a clear link to climate change mitigation and/or adaptation. Given the cross-cutting nature of climate change, this can include a wide range of topics with which climate change interacts and intersects, but the relationship to climate change should be made explicit.
- **AI/ML relevance:** Projects should employ or address AI or ML in a way that is well-motivated and well-scoped for the problem setting. This includes both projects where AI or ML are a central component, as well as those where AI or ML are one among many components. Projects proposing the implementation of AI/ML techniques will not be penalized if other techniques or approaches are found to be better-suited as the project progresses; negative results are welcome if well-tested.
- **Dataset:** The proposed dataset or simulator to be created should serve to enable further impactful work at the intersection of climate change and machine learning beyond the project being proposed. We require the dataset to comply with the [FAIR Data Principles](#) (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable).
- **Pathway to impact:** Proposals should address how their work, if successful, can be deployed or implemented in practice to aid climate mitigation and/or adaptation. This can be addressed in the form of deployments planned as part of the project itself, or via a concrete plan for disseminating the work among relevant sectors or organizations.



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impacts of the proposed solution, including how these risks will be avoided or mitigated in the project's execution. (See, e.g., the [NeurIPS ethics guidelines](#) for a discussion of ethical considerations pertinent to ML.)

- **Feasibility:** The scope of the proposed project should be realistic with respect to the associated timeline and budget.
- **Expertise of team:** The proposed team should have demonstrated expertise in areas of relevance to the development and execution of their project, notably the relevant area(s) of climate change mitigation and adaptation and in AI/ML. Interdisciplinarity and diversity within the proposed team will be viewed favorably.

In addition, the following aspects will be considered favorably during the review process:

- **Deployment partners:** Project teams including relevant organizations through whom the proposed work could be impactfully deployed will be viewed favorably.
- **Traditionally under-funded areas of work:** Projects that are impactful but may not be traditionally covered through other funding streams will be given priority as part of this call. Examples include projects that may not fit neatly into one discipline or area of study, or projects serving stakeholders with limited access to capital.
- **Equity:** Projects that explicitly incorporate equity-related considerations – e.g., through the choice of problem addressed, or stakeholders that are partnered with – will be viewed favorably.

Across the full cohort of grantees, we will additionally seek to allocate grants to represent multiple sectors of climate change mitigation and adaptation, as well as coverage across many geographic regions.

Application instructions

All applications must be received by September 15th, 2024 at 23:59 (Anywhere on Earth time, UTC-12). Applications should be made via the [CMT website](#), which will require the following information.

Basic information. The CMT submission portal will require the title and abstract of the proposal; the name, affiliation, and country of the institution of the Principal Investigator; the names, affiliations, and countries of the institutions of all co-Investigators; and additional short declarations about the project. **The first name in the CMT author list will be treated as the Principal Investigator.** Only one Principal Investigator may be named, but there is no limit on the number of co-Investigators. Please



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figures/tables, using no smaller than 12pt font size, single line spacing, and 1 inch margins), with unlimited additional pages allowed for references. The Project Description should be submitted as one PDF attachment via CMT, and include the following subsections (please use the same order and headers to separate the subsections):

- Project title, the name and affiliation of the Principal Investigator, and the names and affiliations of any co-Investigators.
- **Summary:** A short description of the proposed project of up to 250 words.
- **Project Outline:** A detailed description of the proposed project. This section should address both the proposed methodology (e.g., machine learning) and application area (a climate change-relevant topic), and should explicitly address what gap the proposed project fills in climate change mitigation or adaptation, as well as why the proposed methodology is useful and appropriate for addressing this gap. Projects in the Special Track on Dataset Gaps should follow the instructions under “Dataset Plan” below when writing this section, since the Project Outline will focus primarily on the gap filled by the dataset and how it will be created.
- **Deliverables:** A description of what concrete deliverables (e.g. papers, code, datasets, deployed systems) are expected from the project.
- **Timeline:** A timeline for key milestones of the project, aligned with the deliverables described above.
- **Team:** A description of the relevant expertise of each team member and how it relates to the project.
- **Pathway to Impact:** A plan for how the proposed work will have an impact on GHG emissions or societal resilience to climate change. This should be as specific as possible. It is not required that deployment take place within the duration of the project, but all projects should be scoped and developed in such a way as to facilitate impactful deployment in future. At a minimum, this section should address: how the authors plan to engage with end users/other relevant stakeholders during the project, which stakeholders will make use of this work, how exactly it will be useful for these stakeholders, and considerations that are necessary to facilitate impactful deployment (bearing in mind the potentially different incentives for various stakeholders involved).
- **Dataset Plan:** All projects must propose a new dataset that will be created and made publicly available in compliance with the [FAIR Data Principles](#) (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable). “Creation” of a dataset may include annotating data with labels, collecting



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what it will contribute (as compared to existing datasets), and what will be done to create the dataset. The description should also include a detailed plan for how the data will be documented, shared and preserved, in particular elaborating in detail how compliance with each of the [FAIR Data Principles](#) (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable) will be ensured. Note that teams will be required to use [datasheets](#) to document their created datasets. Projects in the Special Track on Dataset Gaps should include the content described for the “Dataset Plan” section as part of the Project Outline section above, since the Project Outline will focus primarily on the gap filled by the dataset and how it will be created.

- **Equity Considerations:** This section should describe equity-related considerations related to the project, and how the team will shape the project with these in mind. This discussion may include the nature of the research, composition of the team, and/or nature of the stakeholders outside the team who will be worked with.
- **Ethical Considerations:** A description of any broader ethical considerations associated with the development and deployment of the work, including but not limited to those connected to climate change. This section should include a description of potential societal impacts or side effects, as well as factors to bear in mind to mitigate negative effects, including important stakeholders to include.

Budget and Budget Justification. An itemized Budget (1 page) indicating the total amount requested and how these funds will be used if a grant is awarded, and a brief Budget Justification (1 page) of these amounts, submitted as one PDF file through CMT. Eligible expenses include salaries for Investigators, students, and other research staff; materials, equipment, software, and compute; and expenses associated with conferences and other project-related travel. The Budget should also indicate any institutional overhead, at a maximum rate of 10% of the total amount requested. If this project has other sources of funding, the Budget should make clear which research activities are proposed to be funded by the present grant, and which research activities are funded by other sources. Please note that funds will be contracted solely to the accredited university with which the Principal Investigator is affiliated; any further dissemination of funds to partner institutions must be managed by the lead institution.

We encourage you to use this [Budget Template](#) and adapt it to your project needs by adding or subtracting lines and/or columns to it.

CVs of key personnel. CVs for the Principal Investigator and all co-Investigators, as a single PDF file (no page limit).



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Climate Change AI is a non-profit initiative to catalyze impact from at the intersection of climate change and machine learning. Since it was founded in 2019, CCAI has inspired, informed, and connected thousands of individuals from across academia, industry, and the public sectors, through its foundational reports on AI and climate change, networking and knowledge-sharing events, educational initiatives, and global grants programs. See [our website](#) for further details.

Process Chairs

[Millie Chapman](#)

[David Rolnick](#)

[Baosen Zhang](#)

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Grant Eligibility

Q: What is the definition of “university” under the eligibility criteria?

A: We define a university to be an accredited, degree-granting non-profit institution.

Q: What counts as an OECD Member country under the eligibility criteria of this grant?

A: This refers to the 38 OECD Member countries listed on [this OECD website](#). These countries are: Australia, Austria, Belgium, Canada, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Czech Republic, Denmark, Estonia, Finland, France, Germany, Greece, Hungary, Iceland, Ireland, Israel, Italy, Japan, Korea, Latvia, Lithuania, Luxembourg, Mexico, Netherlands, New Zealand, Norway, Poland, Portugal, Slovak Republic, Slovenia, Spain, Sweden, Switzerland, Türkiye, United Kingdom, United States.

Q: I am not an AI or ML expert; can I apply?

A: Yes, as long as your project includes an aspect of AI/ML which addresses one of the areas described in “Purpose of this grant”. You may want to consider finding an AI or ML expert to collaborate with; our [workshops](#), [online discussion platform](#), [happy hours](#), and [community directory](#) could be helpful for this.

Q: I am not a climate expert; can I apply?

A: Yes, as long as your project addresses a problem of climate change, with a pathway to impact clearly described. You may want to consider finding an expert in the relevant climate-related domain to collaborate with; our [workshops](#), [online discussion platform](#), [happy hours](#), and [community directory](#) could be helpful for this.

Q: I'm from a non-OECD Member country but currently at an institution in an OECD Member country; can I apply?

A: Yes, as the funds will be disbursed through your institution, not to you directly.

Q: I'm from an OECD Member country but currently at an institution in a non-OECD Member country; can I apply?

A: At this time, you unfortunately cannot apply as a Principal Investigator; for logistical reasons, we are currently only able to disburse funds to institutions in OECD Member countries. However, you may participate as a co-Investigator in a grant proposal, provided the Principal Investigator meets the eligibility requirements. Our [workshops](#), [online discussion platform](#), [happy hours](#), and [community directory](#) could be helpful in finding collaborators.

Q: Do Co-Investigators need to be affiliated with an institution in an OECD Member country?

A: Co-Investigators do not need to be affiliated with an institution in an OECD Member country. However, due to United States sanctions and export controls, CCAI is unfortunately unable to accept projects with Co-Investigators who reside in the following countries: Cuba, Iran, Syria, North Korea, Russia, and sanctioned parts of Ukraine.



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grant may not apply or receive funds in any way (however, Reviewers may). Current members of the Climate Change AI Board of Directors cannot apply to this grant as a PI, and they may not receive funds towards their own salary. Other Climate Change AI affiliates are welcome to apply in any capacity.

Q: Are doctoral students eligible to be the PI at an eligible lead institution?

A: Anyone who is eligible to be the PI according to the policies of the lead institution is eligible from our perspective. We recommend that you check with your university directly regarding their policies on who can be a PI.

Q: By the grant start date, I will be eligible to hold grants under my name at an accredited university in an OECD Member country. However, at the time I submit my grant proposal, I will not yet be eligible to do so. Can I still apply as the PI on a proposal?

A: This is dependent on the policy of the university at which you seek to hold the grant. We recommend that you check with the university directly.

Q: Am I eligible to apply for these funds if I have applied to other sources for the same research activity?

A: The exact same research activity cannot be double funded. However, this grant may be used to fund a component of a project whose other components are under consideration or have received funding from other sources. This structure should be clearly described in your budget.

Q: Can I apply multiple times with different projects?

A: Yes, you are welcome to apply multiple times. However, as mentioned above, we will seek to select a cohort of grantees “to represent multiple sectors of climate change mitigation and adaptation, as well as coverage across many geographic regions.” This may in turn reduce the probability of multiple proposals from the same team being funded.

Q: I applied for a previous round of the CCAI Innovation Grants program and my proposal was rejected. Can I apply again with the same proposal?

A: Yes, you are welcome to apply with the same proposal. However, make sure to include relevant updates, including an updated budget and budget justification.

Q: I participate(d) in a project funded by a previous CCAI Innovation Grants program. Am I still eligible to apply for the current cycle of the Innovation Grants program?

A: Yes, PIs and co-PIs who already received a grant in a previous year are eligible to apply for the current cycle of the CCAI Innovation Grants. There are two avenues: (i) apply with a new project proposal; or (ii) propose a continuation of an existing project. Re-applying for a grant with the exact same work that has already been funded by the Innovation Grants program is not allowed.



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governmental organizations, or intergovernmental organizations. However, organizations that are subject to United States export control restrictions are not eligible to be deployment partners (see, e.g., the US International Trade Administration [Consolidated Screening List](#)). Additionally, per the stipulations of CCAI's US 501(c)(3) nonprofit status, projects we fund cannot entail political lobbying or campaigning for political candidates.

Application and review process

Q: Can I send my application via email?

A: No, all applications must be via [CMT submission platform](#).

Q: Do I need to use a particular software, like LaTeX or Word, to write the proposal?

A: No, you may use any software to write the proposal, as long as it follows the requirements on length, font, line spacing, and margins.

Q: When submitting my project via CMT, may I select multiple subject areas that my project falls under?

A: Yes, we encourage you to select all subject areas relevant to your project in order to help us identify the most appropriate reviewers.

Q: Is review of the proposals double-blind?

A: No, the review process is single-blind (reviewers' identities are hidden from proposal authors, but proposal authors' identities are visible to reviewers). Proposals are encouraged to be very specific about their pathway to impact, and this is likely to contain de-anonymizing information that reviewers would need in order to evaluate the feasibility of the proposed project.

Q: My proposed project falls under multiple tracks. Which track should I submit to, and will this affect the chances that my proposal is selected?

A: Please submit to the track to which you feel your proposal is most closely aligned. Climate Change AI may move submissions between tracks at the discretion of the Process Chairs. We cannot comment on how a given track will affect the probability that a proposal is selected.

Timeline

Q: I'm uncertain about the start and end dates for my project. What should I do?

A: Just give your best guess, with an explanation of the reasons for your uncertainty if you believe it would help in evaluating your proposal.



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to consider adjusted timelines that make more sense for a particular project. Please be sure to justify any proposed adjustments to the timeline within your application so we can appropriately take this into account. Please note also that proposals with custom start/end dates may be subject to bespoke additional reporting requirements and would need to be able to report at least some substantive progress before the currently-posted end date.

Q: By when do I need to publish my dataset?

A: By the end of the year-long grant, there should be a well-defined plan for data release, with data released no later than one year after the completion of the grant.

Q: When will project funds be disbursed?

A: The grant will be contracted solely to the accredited university with which the Principal Investigator is affiliated. The funds will be disbursed in one transfer, after signing the grant agreement and prior to (or around) the start date of the project. Any further dissemination of funds to partner institutions must be managed by the lead institution.

Q: Can we request a no-cost extension on the grant if the funding is not used up by the end of the project period?

A: We prefer that projects commence and end on the posted start and end dates. However, if there are special and unforeseen circumstances, we are able to consider no-cost extensions of up to a year.

Budget

Q: My project would require a budget greater than the maximum allowed (USD 150K). What should I do?

A: In order to distribute grants equally and fund a larger number of projects, we will not allocate more than USD 150K to a single project. You should describe and apply to us for a USD 150K portion of your project, and apply for additional funding elsewhere. Additional funding sources are allowed, as long as no aspect of the project is double-funded by other funding bodies. Make sure to describe this in your budget, including any additional funding sources you have secured or intend to apply to.

Q: Will you consider proposals that request less than the maximum budget?

A: We will consider project proposals with any budget up to USD 150K. The amount of funding requested is not a criterion on which your proposal will be assessed, and it will not influence our evaluation of your project. We recommend you to propose the budget that you actually need to carry out the project.

Q: My institution takes an overhead greater than 10% of the grant. Am I still eligible to apply?

A: You are still eligible to apply, but you will need to obtain an exemption from your institution regarding overhead, as your institution will not be allowed to take more than 10% overhead.



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then at least \$135K must be direct project costs, and at most \$15K can be overhead.

Q: Is my project allowed to be funded by multiple sources?

A: The proposed project may have multiple funding sources that fund different aspects of the project and/or different sub-projects. However, no aspect of a project should be double funded by other funding bodies.

Q: Does the grant have a cost sharing requirement (i.e., a requirement that the PI supply some percentage of matching funds from another source within the project budget)?

A: No, there is no cost sharing requirement.

Q: Are the costs associated with developing digital apps using AI/ML, such as licensing and software costs, an eligible expense?

A: Yes, the grant can cover the development of digital apps and their associated cost. We also encourage you to discuss this in the “pathway to impact” section of your proposal.

Q: Is equipment cost an eligible expense? Do we need to account for depreciation?

A: Equipment needed to realize your project is considered an eligible expense. Depreciation does not need to be accounted for in the budget.

Q: Can field data collection costs be included in the project budget?

A: Yes, field data collection costs are an eligible expense.

Q: May I use my own format for the budget, rather than using the provided template?

A: Yes, you may.

Scope and relevance

Q: Does this grant call include other environmental or social issues that do not directly pertain to climate change?

A: All proposals should clearly describe the relevance to climate change, as well as the pathway to impact for the climate problem. As problems of climate change intersect with a host of other issues, we welcome grantees to lean into these connections and consider their project holistically.

Q: Does the machine learning proposed in the project need to be ‘novel’?

A: No, in the sense that it is perfectly acceptable to use a previously published ML algorithm or architecture. However, the scientific knowledge generated in this project (e.g. trying the previously published ML technique in a novel setting, combining existing techniques in a novel way, etc.) should be novel, i.e., informative and not previously published.



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problem setting, which may or may not include the development of novel techniques.

Q: The pathway to impact for my project is highly speculative. Will this hurt my proposal?

A: We encourage submissions anywhere on the spectrum from guaranteed-but-small impact to high-risk/high-reward. The important part for evaluation is that you thoroughly and accurately describe the pathway to impact, including your level of uncertainty about any aspects, and take steps to reduce or address uncertainty where possible. E.g., it may hurt your proposal if the speculation is due to lack of prior homework on the climate-related sector at hand, but not if it is due to irreducible uncertainty about future outcomes, physical processes, etc.

Q: My proposed project involves human or animal experimentation that requires explicit ethics approval. Does getting the grant provide this approval?

A: No. You should include in your project description (and budget, if appropriate) any approvals or regulatory oversight necessary for your project, and obtaining those are your responsibility.

Q: Do the projects have to address global-scale problems, or can they address national and/or regional problems?

A: We do not have a preference on the particular geographical scope of the project, beyond its implications for evaluation of the selection criteria listed above. Past winners of the grants program have addressed a diverse range of geographical scopes and locations. We suggest that project teams propose the geographical scope that makes the most sense for their project.

Dataset and Deliverables

Q: Does the dataset have to be for supervised learning?

A: Not at all. In order to enable future impactful work, do ensure that you clearly describe the way you intend the dataset or simulator to be used.

Q: What constitutes publication of a dataset?

A: The dataset must be publicly released in a way that complies with the FAIR Data Principles (Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable). This may take different forms depending on what makes sense for your project (e.g., a static vs. a dynamic dataset).

Q: For the Special Track on Dataset Gaps, what kind of support would be provided by the Google DeepMind researcher? **A:** If your project is assigned support from a Google DeepMind researcher, this individual will be able to provide advisory support at the level of a few hours per week. The exact nature of the advisory support is flexible based on the needs of the project. When you submit your proposal, we encourage you to briefly share the kinds of support that would be most valuable for your project via the relevant question in the CMT submission form.



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there will not be a relevant dataset, in which case the dataset publication requirement can be waived.

Q: In addition to dataset creation, is the creation of open-source software or frameworks desirable?

A: We encourage the creation and dissemination of project components that will catalyze further work at the intersection of climate change and ML. This includes, but is not limited to, datasets and simulators, open-source software and models, digital apps, research publications, etc.

Terminology

Q: What is climate change mitigation?

A: Climate change mitigation refers to the reduction of greenhouse gasses in order to reduce the extent of climate change. As described by the [IPCC Working Group III](#), this “is achieved by limiting or preventing greenhouse gas emissions and by enhancing activities that remove these gasses from the atmosphere.” For examples of where AI and ML can help with climate change mitigation, please see Climate Change AI’s [report](#) on “Tackling Climate Change with Machine Learning.”

Q: What is climate change adaptation?

A: Climate change adaptation refers to activities that aim to prepare for or build resilience to the conditions created by climate change. For more information, please see resources from the [IPCC Working Group II](#). For examples of where AI and ML can help with climate change adaptation, please see Climate Change AI’s [report](#) on “Tackling Climate Change with Machine Learning.”

Q: What is climate science?

A: Climate science is the study of the environmental processes that determine past, present, and future climate. For more information, please see resources from the [IPCC Working Group I](#). For examples of where AI and ML can help with climate science, please see Climate Change AI’s [report](#) on “Tackling Climate Change with Machine Learning” as well as the proceedings of the Conference on [Climate Informatics](#).

Q: What is meant by AI and ML?

A: Artificial intelligence (AI) refers to any algorithm that allows a computer to perform a complex task – typically, tasks such as speech, perception, and reasoning that are associated with human intelligence. Machine learning (ML) is a sub-area of AI referring to techniques that infer patterns from examples (e.g., data). ML is used to describe a wide variety of techniques that range in their complexity, including, e.g., linear regression, decision trees, and deep neural networks.

Q: The project evaluation criteria refer to “equity.” What is meant by “equity” in this context?

A: The word “equity” in this case refers to considerations of diversity, equity, and inclusion (rather



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FAQ

Q: Have you published the names and titles of successful proposals from previous years?

A: Yes, you can read about projects funded during previous iterations of the Innovation Grants program [here](#). In addition, you can find blog posts from prior grantees on the [CCAI blog](#) (you can filter by Article Type: “Innovation Grants”).

Q: What happens if the PI of a proposal changes universities after applying for this grant (with their original institution as the lead institution), but before the grant start date?

A: We are willing to consider switches in the lead institution as long as the lead institution is an accredited university in an OECD Member Country and the PI is eligible to hold grants at the lead institution. Changes to the roles and composition of the team in order to satisfy the eligibility criteria (e.g., rearranging who is a PI vs. a co-PI on the grant) may also be admissible. In all cases, the PI of the proposal should notify us as soon as possible about any changes by emailing us at grants@climatechange.ai.

Q: I have a question that isn't answered here. What should I do?

A: Please contact us at grants@climatechange.ai.



info@climatechange.ai

